

Call for Expressions of Interest

<i>Date of Issue:</i>	September 2026
<i>Expected Completion Date:</i>	May 2027
<i>Project Title:</i>	Automated data extraction from library and archival catalogues
<i>Company:</i>	Manuscripts and Special Collections, University of Nottingham

Contact Details

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Additional Info

<i>Students must sign NDA:</i>	☐
<i>Project uses personal data:</i>	☐
<i>Custom hardware required:</i>	☐
	If Applicable: Please provide details
<i>Relevant research areas (if applicable)¹:</i>	Click or tap here to enter text.

Project Background Information

Manuscripts and Special Collections (MSC), the archive at the University of Nottingham, uses collections management software to catalogue their collections of archive material and rare printed books.

Printed books are catalogued in the library management system, Alma, by Ex Libris. Users can browse Alma catalogue records using the frontend, Primo ([NUsearch](#)).

Archives are catalogued in a system called Calm, by Axiell. Users can browse the Calm catalogue records using the frontend CalmView ([Manuscripts Online Catalogue](#)). More limited versions of Calm records are also available in NUsearch.

Descriptive data from Alma and Calm records is frequently used by MSC staff for the purposes of:

- Creating metadata for digitised images

¹ An overview of different research areas in the school of computer science can be found [here](#).

- Resource lists for classes or enquiries
- Usage statistics

Data is required to be input into the following applications:

- Microsoft Word
- Microsoft Excel
- Microsoft Power Apps (imported into a SharePoint List)

Data is currently typed or copied/pasted manually, which is not only time consuming when required in bulk, but can create incorrect or inconsistent information.

Requirements

The group must provide:

MSC would like to increase the speed and accuracy of data from catalogue records when it is input into other applications.

Catalogue records from library and archive management systems (in most cases) have unique identification numbers linked to the physical object.

Automation of data extraction would allow a staff member to type a book's item number, or an archive's document reference, into a document, and descriptive data is then pulled from the corresponding Alma or Calm catalogue record.

The task would likely involve liaising with staff members who manage Calm and Alma from both Manuscripts and Special Collections, and Content and Discovery (Systems).

Skills

Highly desirable:

Experience with APIs

Desirable:

Experience with library or archival catalogues

Submission / Award information

Date of Submission:

September 2026

Date of Pitch:

October 2026

Notification of award:

October 2026

For further information on this proposal, the team representative should in the first instance e-mail the lead contact stated above at the e-mail address provided.